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**UNIFIL II, ISRAEL, LEBANON, THE UNITED NATIONS
AND THE INTERNATIONAL COMMUNITY:
NEW AND RENEWED PARTNERSHIPS
AND IMPLICATONS FOR MISSION EFFECTIVENESS⁸²**

Efrat ELRON⁸³

As a result of the Lebanon War and in accordance with United Nations Security Council Resolution 1701 of August 11, 2006, UNIFIL's (United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon) mandate was extended and enhanced, and troop strength significantly enlarged. An important number of major European countries and several Asian, African, and Moslem countries have responded to the UN's call, sending troops to Lebanon and contributing to the creation of an upgraded multinational force that is currently deployed on land and at sea.

Peace operations are used in the region in abundance, mostly deployed at the borders between Israel and the neighboring Arab countries. These forces all have the mandate of observing and monitoring, among them UNDOF (United Nations Disengagement Observer Force), deployed on the Israeli-Syrian border; UNTSO (United Nations Truce Supervision Organization), the first UN peace mission whose military observers staff observation posts in southern Lebanon and on the Golan; and the MFO (Multinational Force and Observers), an independent international organization responsible for supervising the implementation of the security provisions of the peace treaty between Egypt and Israel. EUPOL COPPS (EU Police Mission for the Palestinian Territories) and EUBAM (EU Border Assistance Mission) at the Rafah crossing point on the Gaza-Egypt border are recent creations of the

⁸² Proofreading by Anna Peel.

⁸³ The Truman Institute for the Advancement of Peace, Hebrew University and Tel Hai College, Israel.

European Union and the EU's first forces involved in the region.⁸⁴ UNIFIL II is an example of a contemporary peace operation that is mandated to go beyond traditional peacekeeping, holding responsibility for some of the broad spectrum of activities now typical to such operations.

This paper outlines a model describing the effects of the cooperation between UNIFIL II, Israel, Lebanon, the UN, the troop contributing countries (TCCs), and the international community on the effectiveness and success of UNIFIL in fulfilling its mission and mandate. The model presents the knowledge creation, activities and actions UNIFIL stakeholders need to engage in to manage effectively the complex interfaces between them in order to create closer and more effective partnerships.

1. UNIFIL I, UNIFIL II, and the Security Council Resolution 1701

UNIFIL was created in 1978, following the adoption of Security Council Resolutions (SCR) 425 and 426 on 19 March. to confirm Israeli withdrawal from Lebanon, assist the Lebanese Government restore its effective authority in the area and promote international peace and security, It was (and is) deployed in south Lebanon from the Israeli border north to the Litani river and operated under a Chapter Six mandate.

During its long-standing presence in Lebanon, UNIFIL's mandate did not evolve to fit the changing conditions on the ground, and its mission was further complicated by growing disenchantment with UNIFIL's performance and relevance by the various actors involved in the mission or influenced by it. As the conflicting parties did not fully respect or adhere to its mandate, UNIFIL became increasingly irrelevant over time. Moreover, it was regarded by many, including some of its own participants, as collaborating too closely with either Hizbollah or the IDF, depending on one's perspective.⁸⁵ Overall, the Israeli withdrawal did not

⁸⁴ Since the Hamas takeover of Gaza in June 2007, the two missions are no longer actively operating and their future is uncertain.

⁸⁵ Complicating the conceptual debate over the force periodical renewals was the abduction of Israeli soldiers at Har Dov by Hizbollah in October 2000 with tapes relating to the abduction held by the UN for two years, which further overshadowed the basically strained relations between UN and Israel at the time. See also Beker Avi, *The United Nations and Israel - From Recognition to Reprehension*,

result in the restoration of the Lebanese Government's authority, and Hezbollah, supported by Iran and Syria, continued to operate freely in south Lebanon and close to the Blue Line.⁸⁶

To a large extent UNIFIL's failure was a result of too many unresolved conflicting interests and contradictions at the global and regional political level, causing a breakdown in the diplomatic support system of the operation.⁸⁷ A significant decrease in its troop size in 2002 and the gradual withdrawal of its European contingents⁸⁸ further diminished its importance and impact in the region.

UNIFIL I can be seen as a classic case of a difficult mission with an inadequate mandate. Although it made some contributions in stabilizing the area, it did not achieve its basic goals. This failure became more prominent after the signing of SCR 1559 on 2 September 2004⁸⁹, which called upon "all remaining foreign forces to withdraw from Lebanon" and "for the disbanding and disarmament of all Lebanese and non-Lebanese militias." Whilst in 2005 Syrian troops departed Lebanon as a result of intense international pressures and the "Cedar Revolution" mass demonstrations, UN reports indicated that deployment of the LAF in South Lebanon and disarmament of militias had not been implemented,⁹⁰ and Syria still had significant political control over Lebanon⁹¹ The inadequate mandate played a part in allowing a volatile situation to continue and develop over the years, culminating with the

(Lexington, MA: Lexington Books, 1988). For more recent updates that also discuss recent examples of the changing relationships, see Beker Avi, "The UN shows some balance", *Haaretz*, 25.1.1.04, and Dayan Aryeh, "The UN uncut", *Haaretz*, 30.5. 2005.

⁸⁶ For a detailed summary of UNIFIL's history and the related UN Secretary General and Security Council reports and resolutions, see UNIFIL's official web site:

<http://www.un.org/Depts/dpko/missions/unifil>

⁸⁷ MacKinlay, John, *The peacekeepers: An assessment of peacekeeping operations at the Arab-Israeli interface*, (London: Unwin Hyman, 1989); Skogmo Bjorn and Urquhart Brian, *UNIFIL: International peacekeeping in Lebanon 1978-1982*, (Boulder and London: Lynne Rienner Publishers, 1989).

⁸⁸ It needs to be noted that Western forces have gradually been decreasing their participation in the UN peace support operations in the past decade for several reasons, one being their deep involvement in NATO operations and in Iraq, another being the perceptions of the problematic effectiveness of some of the UN operations.

⁸⁹ United Nations Security Council Resolution 1559 (2 September 2004).

⁹⁰ For a detailed analysis of the LAF role in Lebanon, the challenges it faces, the transformations it went through and its prospects for the future, see Barak Oren, "Towards a representative military? The transformation of the Lebanese officer corps since 1945", *The Middle East Journal*, no. 60, 2006, pp. 75-93.

⁹¹ *Progress report on implementation of Security Council Resolution 1559*, Special UN Envoy Terje Roed-Larsen Report, October 25, 2005.

Second Lebanon War. The update Report of the Security Council on 20 July, 2006 indicated that:⁹² “It is clear that UNIFIL, with a very limited mandate, has only been able to play a peripheral role in the current crisis and many have rejected it for the newly proposed international force.”

SCR 1701 ended 34 days of fighting between the IDF and Hizbollah. The Lebanon War was triggered by Hezbollah’s raid from southern Lebanon into Israel, the killing of eight soldiers and the, abduction of two more. It also signaled a dramatic change in the roles of the UN and the international community in the region, calling for a significantly expanded and more robust UNIFIL with an authorized strength of 15,000 troops. It provides for a strengthened mandate coupled with the deployment of the Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF) in South Lebanon, who became jointly responsible for the implementation of the resolution. SCR 1701 is based in part on SCR 1559, with important additions including the creation of a weapons free zone in south Lebanon, a ban on sales and supply of arms to Lebanon except as authorized by its Government, and a call for the delineation of Lebanon’s international borders.

The enhanced UN mission now amounts to well over 13,000 troops from 30 countries. Italy, France and Spain are each contributing two infantry battalions or their equivalent, while Indonesia, Ghana, India, Malaysia and Nepal have one battalion each stationed across southern Lebanon and the Blue Line. The mission has integrated artillery, tanks, armored vehicles, radars and an intelligence capacity, in addition to its main body of light infantry and engineers. Daily patrols have been increased from just a handful to around 400 and new observation posts have been built along the Blue Line. Its maritime task force (MTF), under German command and with more than 1,600 sailors, is the largest naval contingent in UN history. Consisting of fifteen naval ships from Germany, Denmark, Greece, the Netherlands, Norway, Sweden and Turkey, it is responsible for supporting the Lebanese Navy in monitoring its territorial waters, securing the coastline and preventing arms smuggling. The LAF has deployed a large force to south Lebanon for the first time, consisting of four brigades, and is cooperating with UNIFIL in joint patrols and operations, including the destruction of bunkers and arm caches.

⁹² Security Council Update Report No. 5 on Lebanon/Israel, 20 July 2006.

As is the case for most peace operations, UNIFIL's main purpose is to serve as a military means to help achieve a political objective – assisting in achieving domestic stability in Lebanon and contributing to overall regional stability. More specifically, its mandate is positioned between the UN's classic Chapter Six and Chapter Seven, informally referred to as “chapter six and a half”. Its troops can therefore “take all the necessary action in areas of deployment of its force ... to ensure that its area of operations is not utilized for hostile activities of any kind.” In other words, and as stated more explicitly in UNIFIL's Rules of Engagement, there is a mandate to use force beyond self-defense.

UNIFIL's tasks also include “assisting LAF in disarmament of all armed group; assisting the Government of Lebanon, at its request, in securing its borders and other entry points to prevent the entry of arms or related materials”. Stated also in the resolution is the need to address urgently the causes that have given rise to the current crisis, including the unconditional release of the abducted Israeli soldiers. Another important statement in the resolution is the “intention to consider in a later resolution further enhancements to the mandate”.

2. Partnerships and Cooperation in the International Arena – Implications for Mission Effectiveness

Partnerships and effective cooperation in and around a complex entity such as a multinational force need to be based on multiple formal and informal cooperation mechanisms that contribute to the different dimensions of mission effectiveness, as all actors are interconnected in numerous ways.⁹³ Unified goals within the force, over and above the national interests and cultures and in sync with the mandate and mission are essential. No less important are the identification and enhancement of common interests of the parties with a direct interest in the peace that the force is mandated to keep. According to the definition of the SWORD model developed by Max Manwaring,⁹⁴ this is the ‘War for Unity of Effort’.

⁹³ Tetsuro Iij, “Cooperation, coordination and complementarity in international peacemaking: The Tajikistan experience”, *International Peacekeeping*, V. 12, 2, 2005, pp. 189-204.

⁹⁴ Manwaring, Max, D. and John T. Fishel, “Insurgency and counterinsurgency: Toward a new analytical approach”, *Small Wars and Insurgencies*, no. 3, 1992, pp. 276-284.

In the case of UNIFIL, deeper partnerships need to include a mutual change of existing attitudes, approaches, and levels of cooperation of all parties. Such bi-lateral and multi-lateral developments have been taking place continuously since the adoption of SCR 1701 and the deployment of the multinational forces, and more are needed. As this is a dynamic process, and UNIFIL II is a reformed military, organizational and political entity, representing an emerging new mentality and mandate, this is seemingly the best time for all parties to ensure that the means and conditions necessary to fulfill of UNIFIL II's goals and maximize its performance are in place.

A combination of the two closely related factors, successful diplomatic efforts and UN commitment, has been found to predict success in achieving the overall goals of peace operations.⁹⁵ These in turn influence yet another crucial key leading to effectiveness - the fit between the situation on the ground and the missions' mandate,⁹⁶ force size and force composition. Rwanda, Somalia and UNPROFOR in the Balkans are examples of a misfit leading to failure. The level of a mission's success or failure in achieving its overall goals, influences other important performance indicators: from fulfilling the greater vision behind the mandate - the alleviation of human suffering and global peace - to the will and motivation to fulfill the specific mandate, to operational unity within the mission and between the national contingents, the overall positive perceptions of the mission, its effectiveness and significance,⁹⁷ leading to with it the long-term commitment and involvement of TCCs at the national level,⁹⁸ and their troops at the ground level in the fulfilling the mandate.⁹⁹ Other effectiveness indicators are the legitimacy of the mission, as perceived by all those involved as beneficiaries or contributors, the mission's cost effectiveness, and the effective leadership and authority of the force commanders to achieve interoperability and the

⁹⁵ Pushkina Darya, "A recipe for success? Ingredients of a successful peacekeeping mission", *International Peacekeeping*, Vol. 13, no. 2, 2006, pp. 133-149.

⁹⁶ Diehl Paul, Druckman Daniel and Wall James, "International peacekeeping and conflict Resolution: A taxonomic analysis with implications", *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, 1998, pp. 33-55.

⁹⁷ Tomforde Maren, "Motivation and self image among German peacekeepers", *International Peacekeeping*, Vol. 12, no. 4, 2005, pp. 562-575.

⁹⁸ Schoenmaker Ben, "The debate on the Netherlands contribution to UNIFIL", *International Peacekeeping*, Vol. 12, 2005, pp. 586-598.

⁹⁹ See for example, Bennett Jonathan and Boesch Rolf, "Motivation and job satisfaction in the Swiss Support company in Kosovo", *International Peacekeeping*, Vol. 12, no. 4, 2005, pp. 562-575.

mission's goals. All these factors determine the "attractiveness" of the mission to TCCs and highly professional militaries, and are weighed against the level of risk posed to the troops.

UNIFIL II operates in an especially complex conflict theatre. Lebanon's frail democracy is constantly under threat from within and from neighboring Syria and Iran. It is deployed in a volatile region, which suffers from active conflicts in Iraq and the Israeli-Palestinian arena, is shadowed by Iranian nuclear threats, and is renowned for the involvement of many other regional and international players. The complexity of the theater compels the professional militaries involved in UNIFIL to adjust their doctrines and means in a coordinated manner in order to successfully cope with the dynamic and ever-changing challenges.

Despite the complexity, a basic assumption of the partnership model is that Israel, the government of Lebanon, the UN, and the wider international community share the goal of regional stability, as manifested in SCR 1701.¹⁰⁰ Another shared and related basic assumption is the notion that an effective UNIFIL II and an effective mandate is a necessary mean for the achievement of stability. Recent conceptualization and thinking, based on a large body of theoretical models and empirical evidence from the literature in different fields¹⁰¹, reports from the field, reports produced by different NATO and UN bodies - the Brahimi Report¹⁰² being a prominent example - promote effective negotiation and cooperation between all parties that are involved in a conflict as one of the preconditions to its effective management and resolution. Moreover, these partnerships are essential for the operations' internal workings and smooth coordination, as operational effectiveness is inherently challenging in peace operations as they are multicultural organizations consisting of forces from different nations, speaking multiple languages,

¹⁰⁰ The concept of "regional stability" is also in the eyes of the beholder – and Hizbollah, Iran, and Syria for example have very different and versions of the terms that differs from that of the Western and non-western democratic world and the more moderate players in the region such as Jordan, Egypt and Saudi Arabia.

¹⁰¹ For two examples, see several chapters in Richard M. Price and Mark W. Zacher (eds.), *The United Nations and Global Security*, (New York: Palgrave, 2004), and Lipsky, David B., Ronald L. Seeber and Richard D. Fincher, *Emerging Systems for Managing Workplace Conflict*, (Jossey Bass, 2003).

¹⁰² Brahimi, Lakhdar, Report of the panel on United Nations peace operations, UN Security Council, A/55/305-S/2000/809 (August 21, 2000); NATO, AJP – 9, NATO Civil-Military Co-operation (CIMIC) Doctrine, <http://www.nato.int/ims/docu/AJP-9.pdf> (12 Dec 2006).

and representing a variety of cultures and military traditions.¹⁰³ Furthermore, it is a circular relationship - as a more effective force, UNIFIL has the potential of strengthening the partners and their partnerships on the ground and at the political levels, and this reputation of competency and success tends to give rise to more achievements and accomplishments in a perpetual cycle.

In the case of SCR 1701, what then are the necessary present and future conditions and actions necessary to enable its successful implementation? We will now turn our focus to the international and inter-military cooperation as mutually affecting each other, and the effects of both on the mission's effectiveness.¹⁰⁴ First and foremost is the significant and continuing involvement and commitment of all parties in fulfilling the mandate and ROE. A precondition is a basic belief in the usefulness of both as means of achieving the overall goal, and in their possible and positive implications on the conflict situation. In UNIFIL's case, there is a consensus on the potential of SCR 1701 as bringing a positive change in the theater, also from the Lebanese and Israeli governments.

The most compelling signal of involvement on the ground is that it is the largest contribution of Europe and the EU to any current UN force¹⁰⁵, and the quickest deployment of any UN force of such magnitude. Four European states - Italy, France, Germany and Spain - dominate the force, along with their democratic values and highly professional and well-equipped militaries. The contribution of forces from Moslem and Arab countries - Indonesia, Malaysia, Turkey and Qatar - further enhances UNIFIL's legitimacy and acceptance in the region.

TCCs are motivated to participate in peace operations for various reasons and if their specific goals are satisfied positive perceptions of the peace operation are enhanced, which in turn strengthens the will to contribute to the mission. Joining the war on terror and strengthening democratic principles around the globe is one motivation. Other motivations include the ability to influence global and regional politics, and contributing to the burden of global security. Having a good

¹⁰³ Elron, E., Halevy, N. Shamir, B., & Ben-Ari, E., "Cooperation and coordination across cultures in the peacekeeping forces: Individual and organizational integrating mechanisms", in A. Adler and T. Britt (Eds.), *The psychology of the peacekeeper: Lessons from the field*, Praeger Press, 2003.

¹⁰⁴ Due to the scope of this paper, the topic of CIMIC will not be explored.

¹⁰⁵ In fact, UNIFIL's is Europe's first large scale contribution to the UN since Bosnia; see *Annual Review of global peace operations*, Center on International Cooperation, New York University, 2007.

reputation while doing this increases both visibility and influence in international bodies like the UN, NATO and EU. Take, for example, Italy's aspirations to become a more prominent force in Europe, Germany's wish to burnish its military's reputation and Turkey's aspirations to raise its international profile as it strives to join the European Union as well as to reassert Turkish influence in its region. All these motivations align with the formal UNIFIL mandate and goals, as well as its perceived importance. An additional result of aligned motivations has enhanced feelings of accountability of the troops on the ground. These are transmitted by the nations in pre- and post deployment training and throughout the service on the mission¹⁰⁶.

There are considerations at the national level that are a potential faultlines between the contingents and their respective TCCs. The level of risk to soldiers' lives is one, the possible increased risks of a terror attack in the home country as a result of participation is another. Financial considerations and allocation of resources always play a crucial role in national theatres, especially in Europe and North American for their troops are heavily involved and deployed within the NATO framework. All these consideration are also weighed against the perceptions of an operation's success and importance.

A consequence of countries having different motivations is manifested in the interpretation of the ROE of an operation, the level of willingness to engage in active combat, and the extent to which national restrictions and caveats are imposed on troops. The current case for ISAF in Afghanistan is a well known example¹⁰⁷, and the question of how actively to engage in the disarming of the Hizbollah and other militias is the case for UNIFIL. Distinct perceptions and goals of different countries can hamper, in many respects, the headquarters ability to effectively

¹⁰⁶ Based on interviews and observations of Italian military pre-deployment training before joining UNIFIL, and on numerous interviews summarized in Elron, E., Halevy, N. Shamir, B., & Ben-Ari, E., "Cooperation and coordination across cultures in the peacekeeping forces: Individual and organizational integrating mechanisms", in A. Adler and T. Britt (Eds.), *The psychology of the peacekeeper: Lessons from the field*, (Praeger Press, 2003).

¹⁰⁷ See a summary in French N. N., "Our seven wars in Afghanistan: Progress under the SWORD model", *The Pearson Papers*, Vol. 10, no. 1, 2007. One prominent example is NATO's summit meeting in Riga, where prior to the summit, a request to restate their national restrictions on troops was circulated to all nations. The request also included a pledge for aid to NATO partners whose troops were in danger, even if the day-to-day rules of some countries restricted offensive operations. As a result some nations did remove some of their operationally restrictive caveats, allowing ISAF commander to use 2000 troops to a greater effect (U. S. General James L. Jones, outgoing Supreme Allied Commander Europe, the Atlantic Council meeting, December 21, 2006).

command its mission— the difficulty of moving forces beyond specific areas of deployment or unwillingness of rescuing troops from another contingent when needed are cases in point. Moreover, perceptions of unfairness when some troops take greater risks than others also impede cooperation between contingents and affects troops' motivation. Nevertheless, at times, overall good cooperation can lessen the impact of these rifts. The next section focuses on the current cooperation and coordination mechanisms between UNIFIL, the IDF and the LAF and their positive effects on the implementation of SCR 1701.

3. Implementation of Cooperation on the ground: Coordination and Liaison Mechanisms

The success of the cooperation between the parties on the ground is highly dependent on the coordination and liaison mechanisms implemented at the strategic and tactical levels. While the primary goal of liaison mechanism is to relay information on current incidents and future events in order to prevent violence and misunderstandings, the more comprehensive coordination systems also serve as means to several ends that affect mission effectiveness: bringing together knowledge and doctrines accumulated in each of the militaries, shared learning, the creation of new and important knowledge about the theatre, enhanced decision making capabilities specific to the mission, and improved troops' actions and reactions. It also allows deeper insights and knowledge of all relevant parties of their partners, and in turn the identification of mutual overall interests, the safety of UN personnel being one example. No less important, it allows an understanding of relevant organizational and national differences – in terms of operational conduct, command structures, definitions of professionalism, interests, motivations, and cultural values and emphases as they are manifested on the ground. In UNIFIL's case it is essential that high levels of knowledge and familiarity will also exist between UN headquarters and the DPKO, the individual TCCs and their militaries, Lebanon/LAF, Israel/IDF,¹⁰⁸

¹⁰⁸ It needs to be noted that the Israel and the IDF are unique recipients of peace operations in terms of IDF capabilities that are similar to those of the European contingents.

NATO (who operate in other arenas and many of UNIFIL's European troops have served under its command), and the EU.¹⁰⁹

As a reflection of the global arena, coordination is possible at both the bi-lateral and multi-lateral levels. Specific to UNIFIL's history and the fine line it treads between the conflicting interests of Israel, the Lebanese government, Hezbollah, and many others, close coordination can also pave the establishing the trust, confidence and mutual respect required for an effective mission. More specifically, efficient cooperation can lead to changes in perceptions: from "enemies" to partners, from a mission with an irrelevant mandate to a mission with promise, from stereotypes to personal and professional perceptions, to adjustment of expectations and wishes related to UNIFIL's role.

The cooperation and coordination mechanisms implemented and the actions taken to enhance their effectiveness include:

- DPKO's creation of a Strategic Cell responsible for UNIFIL II only. The Cell was created as a response to the complexity of the operation and to the requests of the main European TCCs. The Cell consists of around 30 officers, proportionally representing the TCCs. The cell serves as an instrument for enhanced military guidance at the strategic level, whilst simultaneously allowing the DPKO more direct connections with the forces on the ground, a better understanding of the specific contingents and their needs and challenges, and more closely coordinated decision making processes.¹¹⁰
- Regular and effective tri-partite meetings of UNIFIL, IDF and LAF senior officers, run by the UNIFIL force commander. Discussion can include violations of SCR 1701 by both sides, activities related to better demarcating the Blue Line and actions required to enhance bi-lateral liaison and coordination mechanisms between UNIFIL and the two militaries.
- Frequent bi-lateral meetings between UNIFIL's Force Commander and senior officers in the IDF and LAF which strengthen the role of UNIFIL as mediator of the conflict.

¹⁰⁹ Knowledge of Hizbollah, terror and terrorist organizations, local and influential actors, such as Iran and Syria, is indeed crucial, but is not part of mutual knowledge creation.

¹¹⁰ It must be noted that while there are many advocates of the strategic cell, who tend to see this as a test case for other large missions, there are those who believe it undermines the established UN command structures, by adding a further layer between UN DPKO and the ground.

- Additional liaison units in the IDF and LAF at the regiment level, battalion level (LAF), in the navy, and in the air force (IDF) have been put in place.
- Significant enhancement of existing liaison units at the brigade and headquarters level of in terms of personnel and resources.
- More direct communication channels between the liaison units, and easier access to their commanders and senior officers.
- Participation of LAF officers in UNIFIL's Joint Operation Center.
- Establishment of a UNIFIL office at the IDF Northern Command headquarters manned by two officers from the liaison unit.
- Increased accessibility of UNIFIL commanders to high level IDF and LAF officers in emergency situations.
- More frequent attendance of UNIFIL officers in conferences and events both in Israel and Lebanon.
- More frequent bi-lateral and tri-lateral visits to UNIFIL AO and Israel by senior military officers and high level political representatives from TCCs.
- Significantly higher levels of information and intelligence sharing regarding the situation and threats in South Lebanon at different levels.
- Instructions to units on both sides of the border to exercise more caution and act in a less provocative manner when dealing with situations that can evolve into frictions.
- Increased use of media to convey information about UNIFIL to the public in both Israel and Lebanon.¹¹¹

One of the common threads in all the measures and actions taken is allowing the space and time for closer and more personal interactions. These in turn allow the establishment of common rules of interaction and the creation of higher quality solutions to challenges at the tactical and strategic levels.¹¹²

Reports from all parties, official and un-official, have repeatedly indicated that the enhanced coordination mechanisms have so far facilitated closer, more effective cooperation than ever before. A realistic

¹¹¹ General Graziano's recent interviews with the Israeli *Jerusalem Post* and *Yediot Achronot* are an example.

¹¹² DiStefano Joe and Maznevski Martha, "Creating value with diverse teams in global management", *Organizational Dynamics*, Vol. 29, no. 1, 2000, pp. 45-63.

test of the effectiveness of the coordination mechanism is the dealing with the incidents and frictions as incidents are bound to happen not only between foes but also between friends in such a complex setting involving such a wide spectrum of issues and relationships. To date, escalations of incidents were prevented, with the aid of the enhanced communication and trust. One concrete example is the exchange of fire between the IDF and the LAF across the blue line on 7 Feb. 2007. A far more serious incident was essentially contained in large part because of efficient liaison activities on the ground and the effective relationships created between the liaison units and officers over time. At the next tripartite meeting, less than a week after this clash, despite UNIFIL's having reprimanded both parties for violating resolution 1701, all agreed with UNIFIL's recommendation to improve coordination and the need for discussions of the alternatives of achieving yet smoother liaison (e.g., reduce reaction times and implement a mechanism for conducting emergency meetings). The tripartite meeting was preceded by intense talks of the force commander with senior Lebanese officials, including Prime Minister Siniora and the LAF chief of staff – UNIFIL's stable and regular good cooperation with the Lebanese authorities have helped in easing the tensions created.

Nevertheless, interviews conducted for the study repeatedly indicate that formal learning mechanisms and knowledge creation at the deeper levels both within UNIFIL, the IDF, the TCCs and DPKO need further enhancements. As two examples, familiarity among most IDF commanders and soldiers with UNIFIL's mandate, structure, operations is lacking at best. The in-depth knowledge of UNIFIL troops and personnel regarding the nature and history of the Lebanon War and the lessons learned from it, the regional conflict and the actors involved in it, the IDF, and Lebanese and Israeli cultures is in a similar state.¹¹³ As effectiveness is also related to knowledge beyond the merely daily operational level, especially at the commanders' levels, the creation and dissemination of these understandings must be integrated into the formal training and learning processes of participants on the ground.

¹¹³ At present, only a handful of UNIFIL commanders and IDF officers situated in Lebanon are in direct contact and troops not allowed to cross the border to Israel.

4. Current State of Affairs

SCR 1701 and UNIFIL II in its new form have been in existence for only a short time. It is, however, good timing to reflect on its initial relatively positive results, and on the problems that still need to be resolved through better coordination and international cooperation.

At the immediate level, UNIFIL II's new found enthusiasm in fulfilling its mission has generated significant results. Israeli withdrawal has been completed without incidents, the ceasefire is being adhered to, Hezbollah is no longer situated at the border with Israel or alongside UNIFIL posts, the actual separation between the IDF and Hezbollah is effective, the negotiations on issues such as Rajar village, the Blue Line demarcation and Shebaa farms are advancing with partial implementation, some of the areas contaminated with unexploded ordnance have been cleared, humanitarian assistance operations are conducted on regular basis, including troops' involvement in various projects, and overall UNIFIL's area of operation is more stable and quiet than has been the case for many years (at the same time, reports of relatively minor violations and Israeli over-flights continue and there is still no direct bi-lateral communication between IDF and LAF).

The wider picture however is a darker one. The UN force is deployed in an extremely complex situation, and the restrictions in its mandate mainly in terms of its limited area of operations and disarmament activities may limit its contribution to the region's short and long-term stability. Both the March and June 2007 reports of the Secretary -General to the Security Council warn of several problems and weaknesses: Iran and Syria are involved in unlawful transfer of arms and munitions to Hizbollah and other armed groups in violation of the embargo;¹¹⁴ Lebanese border customs critically lack equipment and training; and the armed groups have been only partially disarmed at best. The LAF are facing capacity challenges which impacts on their ability to quickly respond to UNIFIL requests. Lastly, UNIFIL remains subject to the differences between contingents, mainly relating to the will to use

¹¹⁴ The report refers to intelligence evidence shared by Israel and the Lebanese authorities with the UN and TCCs; see also public proclamations by Hizbollah leader, Hassan Nassrallah, on 16 February stating Hizbollah's intention to move munitions to the "front" and claiming the presence of Hizbollah fighters in South Lebanon.

force when necessary and to differences in military standards and equipment.

While actors on the ground grow stronger (IDF, LAF, Hezbollah, Syria, and Iran), UNIFIL operates within the need for the delicate balance that is typical of many peace support operations – being deterrent on the while getting the support Israel and Lebanon with all its factions and at the same time taking into account the specific threats against its troops.

Overshadowing this situation is Lebanon's fragile democracy, political impasse, and the growing internal violence. Despite regional and international efforts to encourage dialogue and compromise between Lebanon's factions, the political struggle that has paralyzed Lebanon since the assassination of Rafik Hariri and 22 others in a massive suicide truck bomb in Beirut, continues. Despite the departure of the Syrian army in 2005, the Lebanese parliament suffers a deadlock. At the heart of the dispute are Lebanon's ties with Syria. Its pro-Syrian Parliamentary speaker supports the Hizbollah dominated opposition, which is also tied to Iran and has for months prevented the Parliament from meeting at all. The UN Security Council adapted SCR 1757 on 30 May 2007, thereby unilaterally establishing an international tribunal through which to investigate Hariri's murder. Resolution 1747, on 24 March 2007, also provided an international response to the situation by toughening sanction against Iran.

Warnings by Lebanon's pro-Syrian president, Emil Lahoud, indicated that setting up the tribunal could trigger a wave of violence. Subsequently, three bombs exploded in the Beirut area, and fighting broke out between the extreme Islamist al-Qaida supported militant Fatah al-Islam and the LAF at Nahr el Bared, the northern Palestinian refugee camp. At least 130 soldiers, Fatah al-Islam rebels and civilians have been killed by the time of the writing, and additional fighting had broken out in a camp within UNIFIL's area of operation. Lebanon's prime minister vowed to uproot the groups, and to strike at any sign of terrorism. The international community also voiced strong support, partly demonstrated by shipments of arms to the LAF.

5. Conclusions and Future Implications

The implementation of resolution 1701 remains a barometer, not only of the will and commitment of the international community to support sustained stability in the Middle East, but also of the UN's ability to successfully lead an active, complex peace operation in an especially intricate arena. The history of peace-making and peacekeeping forces world-wide is studded with both accomplishments and failures, and performance in this particularly important operation serves in many respects as a test case. The eyes of many are watching UNIFIL closely, and whilst the operation currently provides a source of optimism, in view of its potential to demonstrate international cooperation and renewed significance on the ground, the dangers of returning to relative ineffectiveness and problematic reputation are continuously "lurking around the corner". To this end, existing international and military cooperation need to be maintained, and additional significant steps need to be taken to ensure UNIFIL's continued meaningfulness. What more can be done to enhance UNIFIL's chances of success in achieving its overall mandate?

First and foremost, UNIFIL's new and welcome commitment must be continuously matched by ongoing international support and assistance not only to UNIFIL troops, but also to Lebanon, Israel, and the wider Middle East region.¹¹⁵ In line with the paper's main theme, and in the words of the departing Military Adviser to the DPKO, a crucial step in managing complex tasks "requires a rise in operational flexibility and innovative relationships with regional organizations and individual Member States".¹¹⁶

The notions of cooperation and flexibility, combining the diplomatic and the operational levels, will be best used in accordance with the new doctrines of peacekeeping, where a consensus emerges - in complex conflicts and emergencies, where the level of consent of some of the parties is uncertain, peace operations need coercive in nature to some

³³ See the debate on how the lack of similar international commitment is central to the failure of international missions in the Israeli-Palestinian arena in Michael Kobi and Kellen David, "Israeli-Palestinian Bi-level conflict zone and its implications for international intervention: What went wrong and what can be done?", *The Pearson Papers*, Vol. 10, no. 1, 2007, pp. 78-108.

¹¹⁶ Major-General Randhir Kumar Mehta, *UN News*, 31 May 2007.

degree.¹¹⁷ To be a credible peace operation, not only does it need to engage in state building, but its forces must be armed and organized according to the situation it is embedded in, and to be perceived as being willing and capable in over-matching whatever opposition they might encounter. Forces are better able to fulfill their mission using a combination of negotiation, consent promotion techniques, deterrence, and the will to use limited force if necessary to protect the population and the mandate. High levels of adaptability, creativity and flexibility displayed in UNFIL's deployment and operations are also critical. Existing empirical and theoretical expertise and models can serve as important guidelines.¹¹⁸

Taking all of the factors of the situation into account, it seems that the risk of not moving forward may be greater than the risk of moving forward. Collective experience demonstrates that allies to peace operations need to be proactive, informed, knowledgeable, and coordinated. Short and long-term implications of the risk to peacekeepers' risk need to be taken into account alongside the implications to local and regional stability, European and global security, and UNIFIL's own capabilities and limitations.

Establishment of a high level formal advisory council under the auspices of the U.N. could well prove an effective mean for effective decision making, followed by successful implementation. The council's responsibilities might include active reviewing of SCR 1701 and UNIFIL's mandate and its implementation. It could also provide subsequent recommendation for changes. The council could be made up of diplomatic and military representatives of all parties with a direct stake in the resolution. It could hold regular meetings, consider the expert recommendations of UNIFIL's top commanders, their IDF and LAF counterparts, and professional and academic experts in PSOs and the Middle East.

The guiding principles of the council (or a similar high level cooperation and coordinating mechanism) would be unity of effort combined with the attainment of the deep level of knowledge needed for

¹¹⁷ Jakobsen, Peter, "The emerging consensus on grey area peace operations doctrine: Will it last and enhance operational effectiveness?", *International Peacekeeping*, Vol. 7, no. 3, 2000, pp. 36-56.

³⁶ See Fishel John and Manwaring Max, *Uncomfortable wars revisited*, (Oklahoma: University of Oklahoma Press, 2006), and French, N. N "Our seven wars in Afghanistan: Progress under the SWORD model", *The Pearson Papers*, Vol. 10, no. 1, 2007.

UNIFIL's enhanced effectiveness and the adjustment of its operations and structure to the conditions and larger context the mission operates in. Potential implications of every action taken or not taken need to be considered. The council is just one example of cooperation and knowledge creating mechanism operating under these guidelines – similar lower level mechanisms are also crucial within UNIFIL and with UNIFIL and its partners on the ground, or at the TCC level. It is these processes and mechanisms that can enhance the chances to help the parties in conflict to implement a permanent ceasefire and a long-term solution, perhaps even in achieving, in the words of Resolution 1701, "a comprehensive, just and lasting peace"

An end note – several major events have recently occurred in the ever dynamic theater: a deadly terror attack against a UNIFIL patrol killed six Spanish troops on 24 June, the first direct attack on the UNIFIL forces in their new form. A rocket attack was also launched against northern Israel a week earlier. Coincidentally two important UN reports were issued in June by the Secretary General. The first, written by the recently appointed Special Coordinator for the Middle East Peace Process, Michael Williams, on the implementation of 1701 and among other issues discusses the evidence of rearmament of Hezbollah north of the Litani river as well as the extremist Palestinian factions, the shipments of heavy weapons across the Syrian-Lebanese border, and the two attacks as an indication that weapons and people able and willing to use them remain in South Lebanon.¹¹⁹ The second report, written by an independent group of experts assigned to inspect the Lebanon-Syria border, found no effective controls to prevent arms smuggling, The team highly recommends joint headquarters that will include all the Lebanese security agencies as well as, urgent international aid to be provided in terms of both training and equipment to strengthen Lebanon's ability to secure its borders. It also urges Lebanon to improve its control of its borders with its present capacities.

¹¹⁹ One relevant example is the case made by John Mersheimer in his seminal paper on "The false promise of international institutions", *International Security*, Vol. 19, no. 3, 1994, pp. 5-49.

While many events and reports provide evidence of the overall effectiveness of the renewed UNIFIL-IDF and UNIFIL-LAF cooperation and liaison on the ground, together with the two reports they also present an opportunity and an obligation for all stakeholders in UNIFIL to re-examine the mandate, Rules of Engagement, the cooperation between them, alternative future actions on the ground and at the diplomatic levels to that need to be taken to ensure enhanced security and stability.¹²⁰

¹²⁰ Indirectly, the terror attacks also raise questions, however, regarding the limits of cooperation. For example, who are the partners to an investigation on the terror attack needs to be considered, and cooperation with Hizbollah and Syria in the investigation may seriously limit the uncovering of the culprits, when Iran and Syria may have played a direct or indirect role in the attack as part of their continuous efforts of destabilizing Lebanon. A recent noteworthy analysis of the issue was written by Michael Young from the Lebanese *Daily Star* on 5 July 2007, relying partly on the recent statements made by Javier Solana, High Representative for the Common Foreign and Security Policy of the European Union.